



BAY AREA // SAN FRANCISCO

How the SFNext poll was conducted

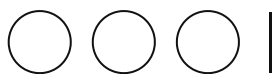
[Read our analysis of the survey results here](#)



Chronicle Photo Illustration

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Updated: Sep. 13, 2022 2:07 p.m.



The SFNext survey is one of the largest and most comprehensive public opinion surveys of city residents conducted in recent decades. A random sample of 1,653 San Francisco residents age 18 and older was asked more than 90 questions about

the state of the city. The survey was conducted from June 27 to July 11, 2022, after District Attorney Chesa Boudin was recalled from office on June 7. Most questionnaires were completed before the new district attorney, Brooke Jenkins, was sworn in on July 8.

Some respondents completed online questionnaires, and others were interviewed by telephone. Jon Krosnick, a Stanford University professor of communication, political science, psychology and sustainability and a nationally recognized authority on survey research, led the design of the questionnaire in collaboration with San Francisco Chronicle editors. The data was collected by the research firm SSRS of Glen Mills, Pa., and analyzed by SSRS and Chronicle data editor Dan Kopf.



Respondents were offered a \$20 gift card for completing the questionnaire. The data was statistically weighted to ensure that the demographics of respondents (e.g., race and education) resembled the city's demographics as determined by the U.S. Census Bureau. The questionnaire could be completed in English or Cantonese, and 92 respondents used the latter.

Here is a collection of articles we have reported off of the results.

The mayor

How unpopular is London Breed?

New poll shows anger with city dysfunction



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Less than a quarter of San Franciscans believe Mayor London Breed has done an excellent or a good job at improving the city, a dismal approval rating that reflects residents' anger with government dysfunction during most of Breed's four years in the city's most powerful office.

[See the story here](#)

The mood

How fed up are San Franciscans with the city's problems?

Residents express pervasive gloom about civic life in the city



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“I’m getting kind of fed up with the city,” said poll respondent Dae Echols, 53, who expects that the high cost of living will force him to move elsewhere when he retires. “I just remember the hippie generation, and it was all about, take care of your friends, brotherly love. And that is totally gone.”

[See the story here](#)

Board of Supervisors

Here’s how bad the job performance rating is for S.F. supervisors

Low marks show that electorate has lost faith in effectiveness of its leaders



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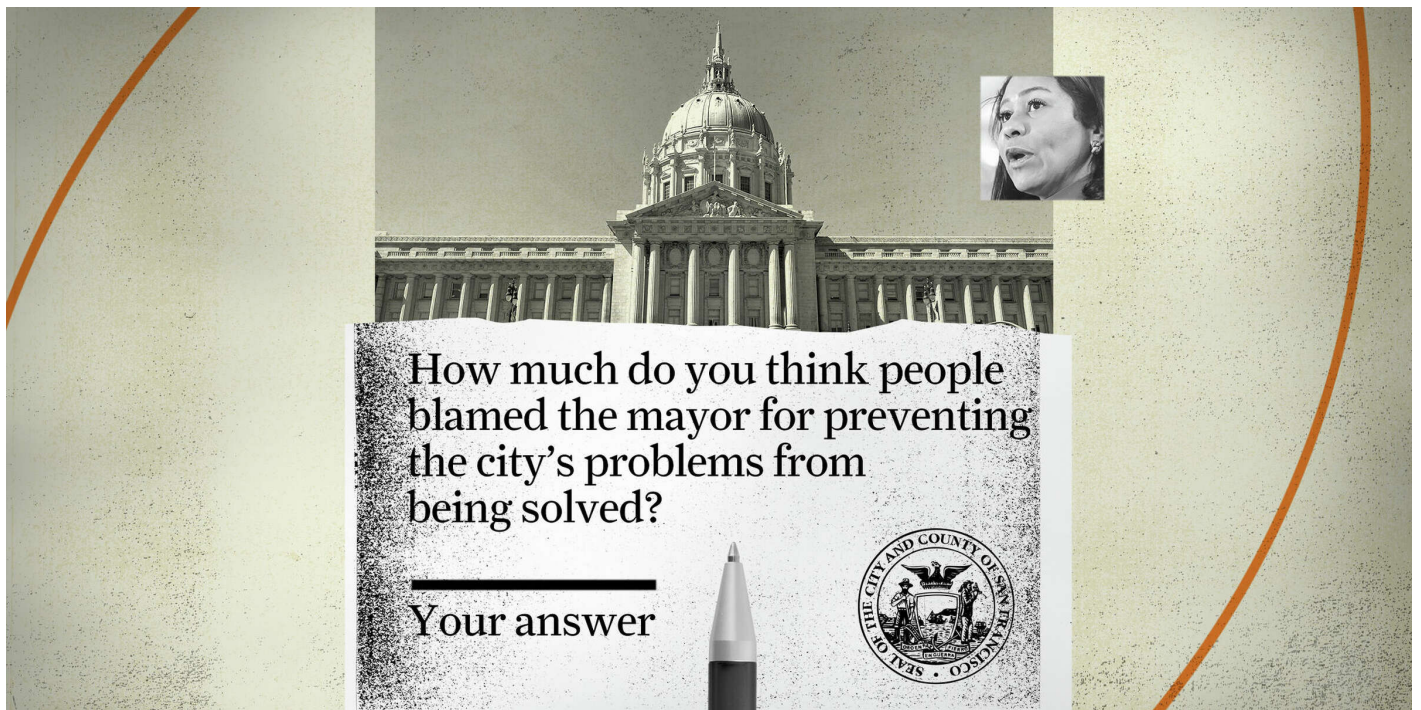
A scant 12% of those age 18 and older believe the supervisors have done a good or excellent job at making San Francisco a better place to live and work.

[See the story here](#)

Interactive quiz

Guess how residents rated San Francisco's leaders in our poll

Check if your estimate matches up with the data



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What's the single biggest reason San Francisco can't solve its biggest problems? When asked that question, about half of San Franciscans say it's the city's government. Here's your chance to speculate about how residents rated the mayor and the Board of Supervisors.

[See the story here](#)

Education

S.F. school board gets worst ratings among city's elected officials

Nearly half of the city's residents said the board is doing an abysmal job

“It’s really polarized now. I wish there was more leadership to bring the communities together.”



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Across all demographics, 48% of respondents said the seven-member board had done a poor or very poor job of making the city a better place to live and work over the last three years. Just 11% of residents surveyed said the school board had done an excellent or good job.

[See the story here](#)

‘Gone downhill’

65% of San Franciscans say the city is worse now than when they moved in

The discontent stems from frustration with S.F.'s biggest, seemingly intractable problems

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Of the 65% of respondents who said the city had gone downhill, the group reporting greatest dissatisfaction was people aged 50-65, with 78% saying things had worsened. Older people were not far behind, at 71%. Long-time residents were also particularly disaffected — of those who moved to San Francisco before 2009, 69% said city life had deteriorated.

[See the story here](#)

Public safety

Here's how many San Franciscans say they've been the victim of a crime

Nearly half of the poll's respondents said they were victims of theft in the last five years

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Opinions and feverish debates about public safety have shaped the most momentous political decisions in San Francisco this year, from Mayor London Breed declaring a state of emergency in the Tenderloin, to the historic recall of a district attorney. But in a city where leaders are constantly groping for solutions, some residents still feel afraid to walk home alone or lock their bikes downtown.

[See the story here](#)

About the poll



As part of the SFNext project to help San Francisco residents solve some of the city's problems, we polled more than 1,650 people to measure attitudes on what's working, what isn't, performance of city government, the future of the city and more.

Send feedback, ideas and suggestions to sfnext@SFChronicle.com

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Chronicle Staff

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